

Exercise 37: The Worst T.V. Show Ever

GLP Group Instructions:

- You work for a new, small television company that wants to break into the big time by having a hit. You realize that people expect the good shows to be on at 9:00 and 10:00 in the evening. But your company is so small that they've decided to go against what is considered common sense and have a midnight hit. It is your job to come up with the idea.
- When watching the Rocky Horror Picture Show for the 20th time, you suddenly are hit with an idea. You look at your friends on the sofa with you and realize that many cult shows gain a loyal following. You decide then and there to create a show that will become a cult legend. You've seen how people love laughing at bad shows so you decide to create the worst show ever and bill it as such. You turn off the TV and look at your friends. "Come on," you say, "We're going to design the worst television show ever."

Purpose:

This activity allows teams to use their creativity and problem-solving skills while working together to brainstorm ideas for a new TV show.

Time Required:

5 min intro/division of teams

40 min brainstorming

15 min debrief

1 hr total

Brief Outline:

1. Advise participants they're going to have a chance to creatively problem-solve. They'll be divided into teams and each team will have the same problem to solve. They'll have 40 minutes to come up with as complete a solution as possible.
2. Read GLP instructions to the flight and divide participants into teams and assign places to work.
3. Start timing. At 30 minutes, advise teams they have 10 more minutes. At 35 minutes, advise groups they only have 5 more minutes. Call time at 40 minutes.
4. Reassemble the teams in one location. Have each team choose a spokesperson to describe their "worst ever" TV show.
5. Ask the group to comment on the other team's ideas. Ask each group to describe the process (or lack of a process) they used to come up with solutions. Ask the participants whether

Debrief:

Brainstorming is not always the best way to come up with a creative solution. Some people may be shy. Politics may influence whose ideas are given more weight. Many people often believe structure cuts down on creativity. However, a structured problem-solving method such as that used by Team B can be successfully used to generate novel solutions. It also works in situations where members can't meet (use email to distribute ideas).